

an abandoned railroad track to see how much air I could get. Now, I cruise in the slow lane and call people “maniacs” when they don’t use their turn signals.

The following are the major factors that will influence your premium:

- **Age.** Younger people are less experienced and often less safe drivers.
- **Gender.** It typically costs more to insure a male, because they are riskier drivers.
- **Car make and model.** A Lamborghini will cost more to insure than my Toyota Corolla.
- **Expected annual mileage.** The more you drive, the more likely it is that you’ll have an accident.
- **Driving record.** If you have wrecked five cars, your premium costs won’t be fun.

This list should teach you a couple of important things about auto insurance and finance. First, if you are trying to decide whether or not you should buy an expensive car, don’t forget to make room in your budget for the increased insurance that is going to come with it. Not only are your monthly payments to purchase the car going to be high, they will be coupled with a high insurance premium. Second, don’t drive recklessly because (1) it is unsafe and careless, and (2) it will cost you more money.

Health Insurance Coverage

Unlike just about every other country in the world, America’s health insurance system is mainly privatized, which means you can